Holding Pattern

S&P −0.22%. Markets tread water ahead of tomorrow's CPI. Gold tops $5,200. Oil continues retreat from $119 peak.

THE SESSION

Markets marked time ahead of tomorrow's CPI. The S&P 500 dipped 0.22% to 6,781.31 in a session defined more by positioning than conviction. The Dow slipped 0.07%, the Nasdaq finished essentially flat (+0.01%), and the Russell 2000 eased 0.22%. The VIX continued its retreat from last week's 29.66 peak, falling 2.24% to 24.93 — still elevated, but no longer signaling acute stress. Breadth was modestly negative, with most of the action concentrated in sector rotation rather than broad selling.

The real story was in commodities. Gold surged 2.02% to $5,207 per ounce — a new record — as investors hedged ahead of the February CPI print. Bitcoin rose 2.70% to $70,277. Oil continued retreating from Monday's $119 overnight spike, with Brent settling near $88 as Trump's "war is very complete" comments from yesterday continued to reset expectations. The 10-year yield held steady near 4.14%.

The CPI release tomorrow morning is the week's main event. Consensus expects headline inflation at 2.4% YoY with core at 2.5%. A soft print would reinforce rate-cut expectations ahead of the March 19 FOMC meeting. A hot print would tighten the Fed's bind further — weak employment plus sticky inflation is the stagflation setup markets have been pricing. PPI follows Thursday.

IOWN Tactical: S&P at ~6,781. Still well above our –20% buy trigger (~5,800 from ATH). Tomorrow's CPI will set the tone for the rest of March. The conflict narrative is fading; the inflation narrative is taking the baton.

IOWN HOLDINGS: NOTABLE MOVERS

WINNERS

SUPV +4.87% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Grupo Supervielle continued its rebound. Argentine financials are benefiting from the broader EM risk-on sentiment as war fears ease.

PDD +2.16% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Pinduoduo gained as China e-commerce remained a non-correlated pocket of strength. Temu's global expansion narrative continues to attract flows.

MATX +2.18% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Matson recovered from last week's shipping disruption sell-off. Container rates are stabilizing as Hormuz transit fears moderate.

LRCX +1.93% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Lam Research extended its recovery for a second straight session, building on the Broadcom earnings tailwind.

CAT +1.68% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Caterpillar added another $12 after yesterday's $24 recovery. Industrial names continue to benefit from oil's retreat from peak levels.

IBIT +1.48% DIGITAL ASSET ETF

Bitcoin ETF tracked the underlying's 2.7% gain as institutional positioning remained constructive.

KEYS +1.25% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Keysight continued its bounce from the March 5–6 sell-off. Test equipment concerns are easing alongside the broader semi recovery.

NVDA +1.16% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Nvidia gained modestly as AI infrastructure demand showed no signs of slowing. The stock remains the anchor of the semi rotation.

DECLINERS

GPC –2.58% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Genuine Parts extended its decline for a second session. Consumer spending concerns continue to weigh on the auto parts distributor.

ADP –2.54% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

ADP pulled back after its +1.60% gain on Friday. The stock dropped to $217 as investors took profits ahead of CPI.

SYF –2.47% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Synchrony fell as consumer credit concerns mounted. Weak payrolls data from Friday continues to pressure consumer finance names.

CNX –2.35% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

CNX Resources declined as natural gas names gave back more of the energy rally with oil continuing its retreat.

SYK –1.99% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Stryker pulled back from recent levels. Medical device names softened on broader healthcare sector rotation.

LMT –1.95% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Lockheed gave back Friday's +2.56% gain. Defense names cooled as Trump's ceasefire rhetoric reduced the war premium.

CVX –1.66% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Chevron fell as oil's retreat continued. The energy trade is unwinding as conflict de-escalation expectations build.

PORTFOLIO PERFORMANCE

DIVIDEND STRATEGY ✗ TRAIL

–0.78%

vs. DVY –0.32% | IWS –0.61%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO ✗ TRAIL

–0.08%

vs. IUSG +0.02%

YEAR-TO-DATE

Dividend +7.31% vs DVY +7.12% / IWS +4.40%
Growth +0.04% vs IUSG –3.05%